

when they look just the way they should – perfect. One would not like to produce the artistic quality effects on all the pictures possessed by one unless one is proficient with the use of powers provided by graphics editing software like Gimp and Photoshop. For those lesser mortals who do not have the magic wands, Ubuntu provides with something called as ‘Shotwell’. It is a photo manager and basic editor, just the way Picasa is on Windows. The difference is that Picasa is a bit more sophisticated and memory hungry than shotwell.

If you want to have real powers at hand, you might like to use GIMP which stands for GNU Image Manipulation Program and has been said to be a competitor of Adobe Photoshop in the past. The Gnome framework has a lot of elements which were actually developed just to create GIMP. Gimp’s interface might feel strange for people who do not like many windows floating around on the screen. Nonetheless it is one of the most powerful image editors available in the world.

If you want to have a really simple image editor, which resembles more like Microsoft’s Paint than Adobe’s Photoshop, we suggest you download and install something called as ‘Pinta’. It is a basic photo editor which allows you to take control of the images with basic tools of drawing lines, rectangles, ellipses and so on. Some more interesting programs include ‘DigiKam’ and ‘F-Spot’.

Games

This is one department when Linux developers seldom look into. The reasons we believe have already been discussed in a previous section. Although there are not many gaming companies which make games for Linux, there are some small time pass games which come bundled with Ubuntu. The two of them which happen to be very interesting are solitaire and Sudoku. The solitaire game which comes with Ubuntu, unlike the one which comes with Windows would allow you to play multiple solitaire card games. Sudoku too is interesting. You may also like to install a chess games (there are many) and enjoy the mental wrestling with your computer.

The following is a non-exhaustive list of games which are freely available for Ubuntu:

- ▶ Bos Wars – A real time strategy game.
- ▶ Chromium – although there is a browser by the same name, this little game wrapped inside the theme of space fight would remind you of the age old video consoles which could produce not more than 256 colors.